Recorded materials:
Before 2026

Future Gazette

A Record of Place, Memory and Everyday Life

FORRES
Moray, Scotland

What Makes A Place?

When we try to understand a place, we usually begin with buildings, streets and landscapes.

However, the meaning of a place often appears through the ways people use and experience these spaces.

The memories of Forres exist across many different layers.

They can be found in the carved patterns of Sueno's Stone, the sounds and stone walls of Tolbooth, the shop doors opening along High Street, the changing seasons of Grant Park, and personal experiences created while walking through Cluny Hill.

Together, these places form a network of memories connected to Forres.

Historic buildings preserve traces of the past.
Natural landscapes shape everyday experiences.
Public spaces bring different generations together.
Community activities allow traditions to continue.

The identity of a town grows through time.
Every walk, gathering and act of care becomes part of local memory.

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Chapter 01

Entering Forres

forres footpaths trust

see forres from a different viewpoint

To Dyke, Kintessack and Culbin Forest
6.2 miles / 10 km (round trip)

Primary road
Main road
Minor road
Railway
Woodland
Park / grassland
Parking
Toilets
Museum
Playpark
Picnic area

To Califer Hill and Rafford
10 miles / 16 km (round trip)

To Altyre Burn via Dava Way
11 miles / 18 km (round trip)

To Dava & Grantown-on-Spey

To Nairn and Inverness

To Kinloss and Findhorn

To Elgin and Aberdeen

To Rafford

Mapping Project supported by Berry Burn Windfarm Community Fund

The Walks shown here are indicative routes that can be used under the Scottish Outdoor Access Code. Whilst following these routes, walkers must respect the Code and are responsible for their own safety and navigation.

KNOW THE CODE BEFORE YOU GO
SCOTTISH OUTDOOR ACCESS CODE outdooraccess-scotland.uk

Walks around Forres

- Mosset Walk — 4 miles / 6.4 km
- Sanquhar/Chapelton/Muiry — 4.5 miles / 7km
- River Findhorn Walk — 10 miles / 16 km
- Short River Walk — 2 miles / 3.2 km
- Town Walk — 1.8 miles / 3 km
- Aircraft and Military Memorial Walk — 8 miles / 13 km
- Forres Engineering - past and present — 11 miles / 18 km
- Grant Park and Cluny Hill — Various paths
- Out of town walks
  - Dyke and Kintessack (6.2 miles / 10 km)
  - Altyre Burn via the Dava Way (11 miles / 18 km)
  - Califer Hill and Rafford (10 miles / 16 km)

For detailed walk instructions see www.forresfootpathstrust.org.uk/walks

The FFT is recognised as a Scottish Charity SC02956

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The representation of a road, track or path is not evidence of the existence of a right of way. The content of this map is believed to be correct at the time of printing. Nevertheless, the publishers cannot accept any responsibility for errors, omissions or changes or for any expense or loss thereby caused.

FORRES TOWN IDENTITY

From Historic Identity to Contemporary Life

MEDIEVAL PERIOD
Royal Burgh Origins

A Regional Centre of Trade

Forres developed as a Royal Burgh, with markets, public spaces and community exchange shaping its identity.

19TH CENTURY
Market & Civic Growth

A Town of Industry and Public Life

Public buildings such as Tolbooth and Town Hall reflected growing civic identity, commerce and industry.

20TH CENTURY
Community Transformation

From Function to Community

As industries changed, public spaces became important places for gathering, events and shared local experiences.

2026
Living Heritage Town

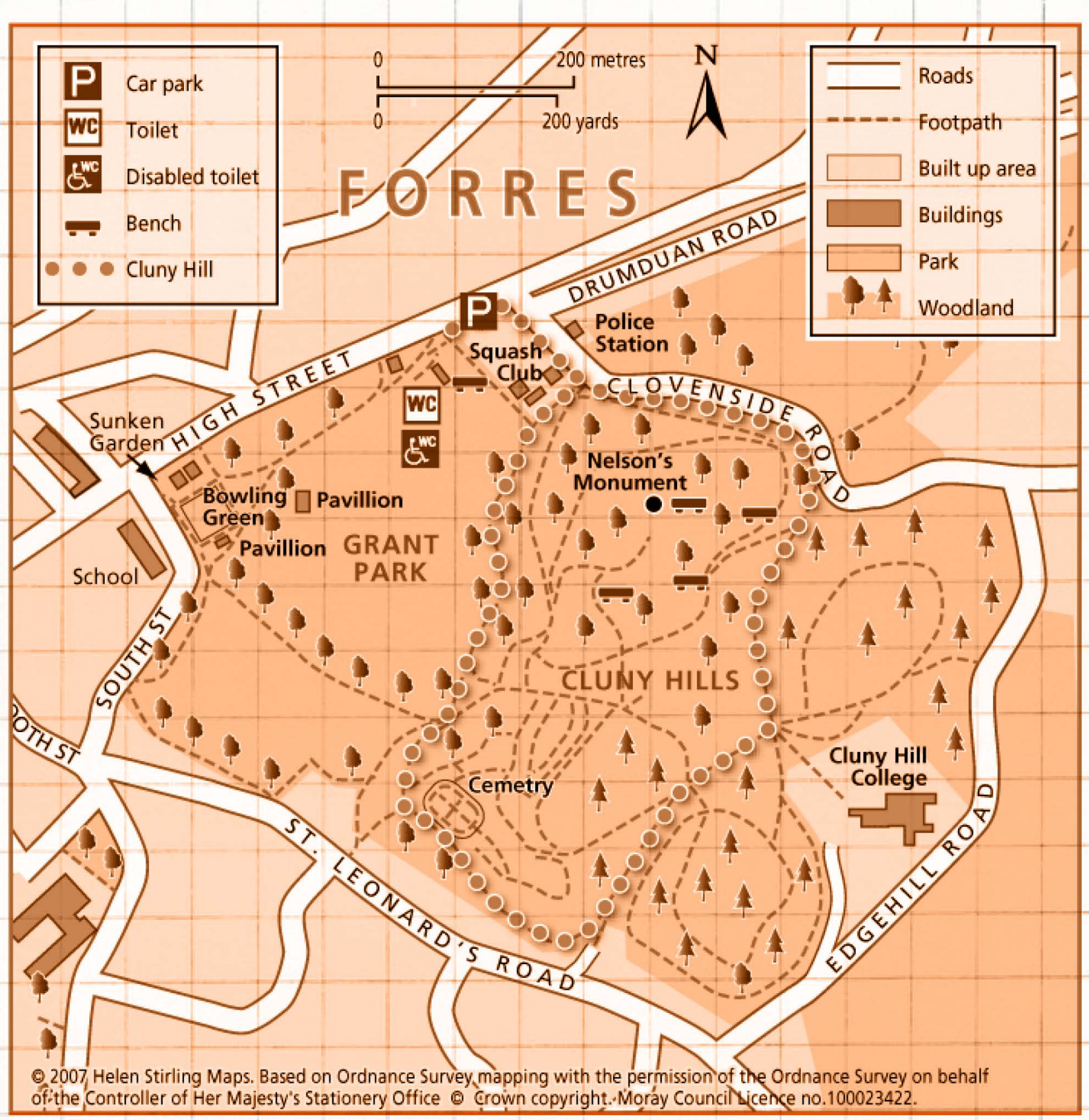
History in Everyday Use

Historic places continue to exist through shops, festivals, community activities and everyday routines.

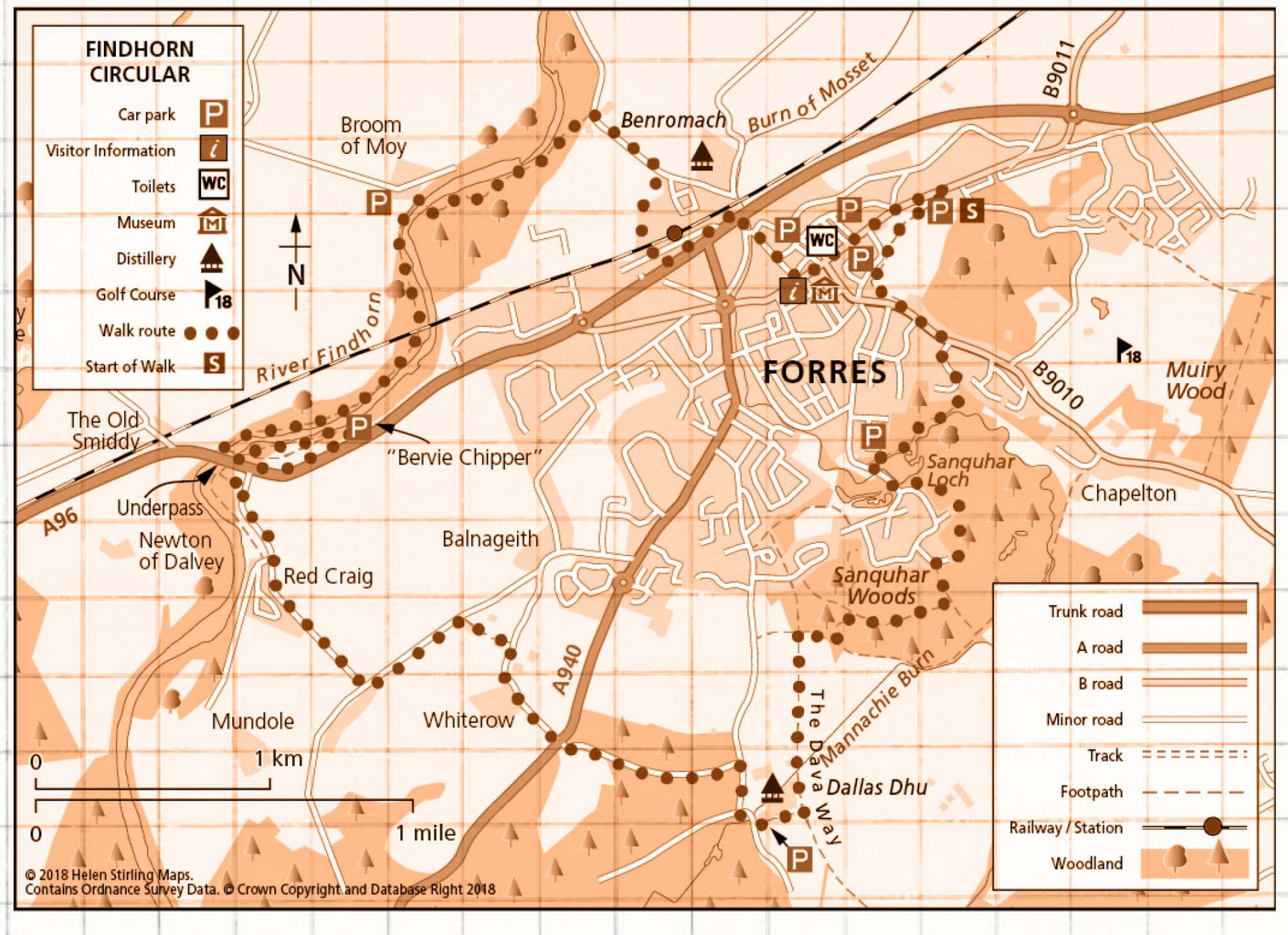
2050+
Future Archive

To Be Continued...

Future generations will continue to add new stories, memories and meanings to Forres.



© 2007 Helen Stirling Maps. Based on Ordnance Survey mapping with the permission of the Ordnance Survey on behalf of the Controller of Her Majesty's Stationery Office © Crown copyright. Moray Council Licence no.100023422.



© 2018 Helen Stirling Maps.
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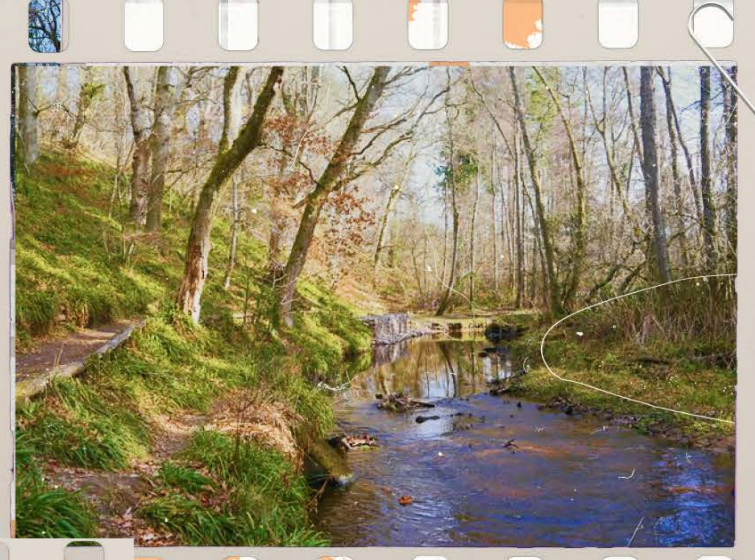
The Landscape Memory

The experience of Forres has always been closely connected with its natural environment. Located in Moray, the town is surrounded by hills, woodlands, rivers and open landscapes.

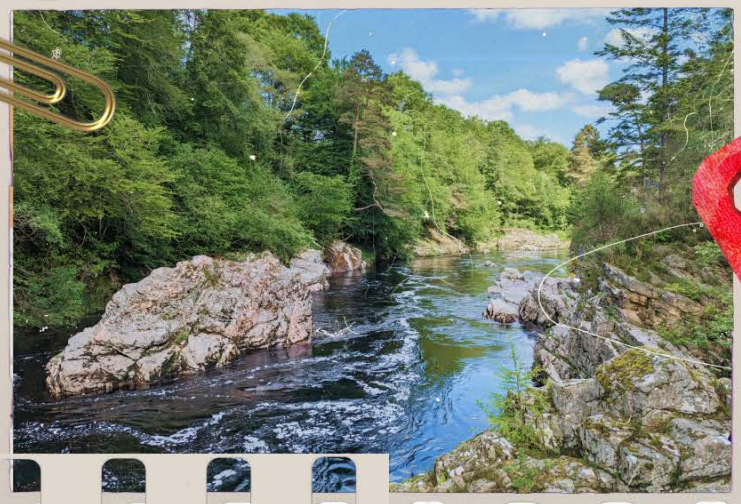
Cluny Hill is one of the most recognisable natural landmarks of Forres.

People walk along the hillside paths to reach Nelson's Tower, where they can view the town and the wider landscape.

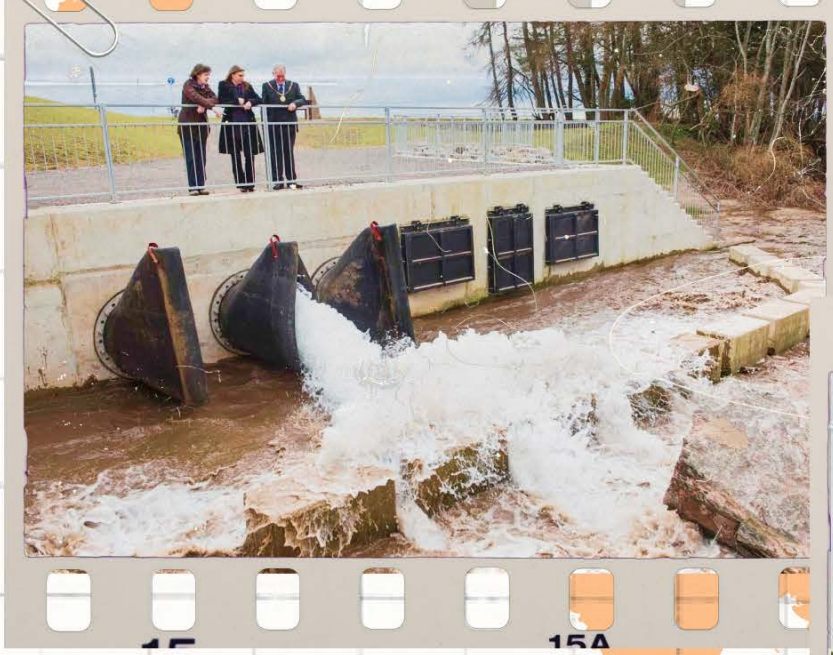
Burn of Mosset, River Findhorn and areas around Pilmuir record the long relationship between the town and water.



These infrastructures often remain hidden within everyday landscapes, yet they continue to protect the community.



Historical flooding affected local life and encouraged the development of flood protection systems.



High Street is one of the most recognisable public spaces in Forres.

Chapter 02

Stones, Streets and Public Memory

High Street is one of the most recognisable public spaces in Forres.

For many people, the first impression of the town begins here.
Buildings from different periods line the street, creating a visual memory through stone walls, windows, shop signs and small public spaces.

High Street The Everyday Centre of Forres

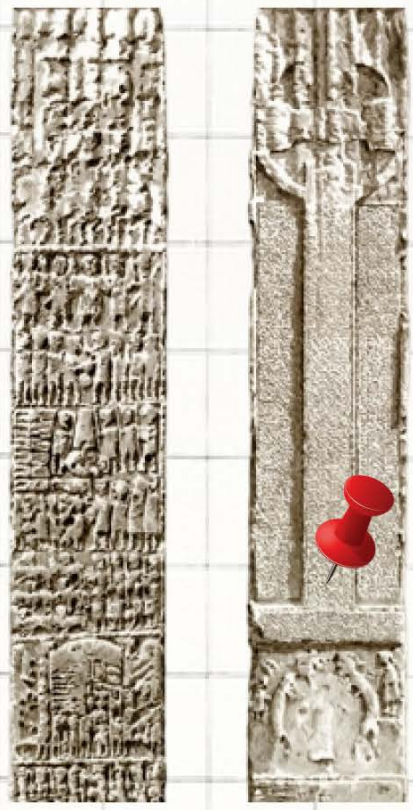
The meaning of High Street grows through daily activities.
In the morning, shops open and residents begin their routines.During the day, people shop, meet and pass through.During festivals and events, the street becomes part of public celebration.
The memory of a street is created through many repeated small moments.An open shop door, a familiar greeting or a short conversation can become part of local life.

Sueno's Stone: Ancient Memory Preserved in Stone

Stone /

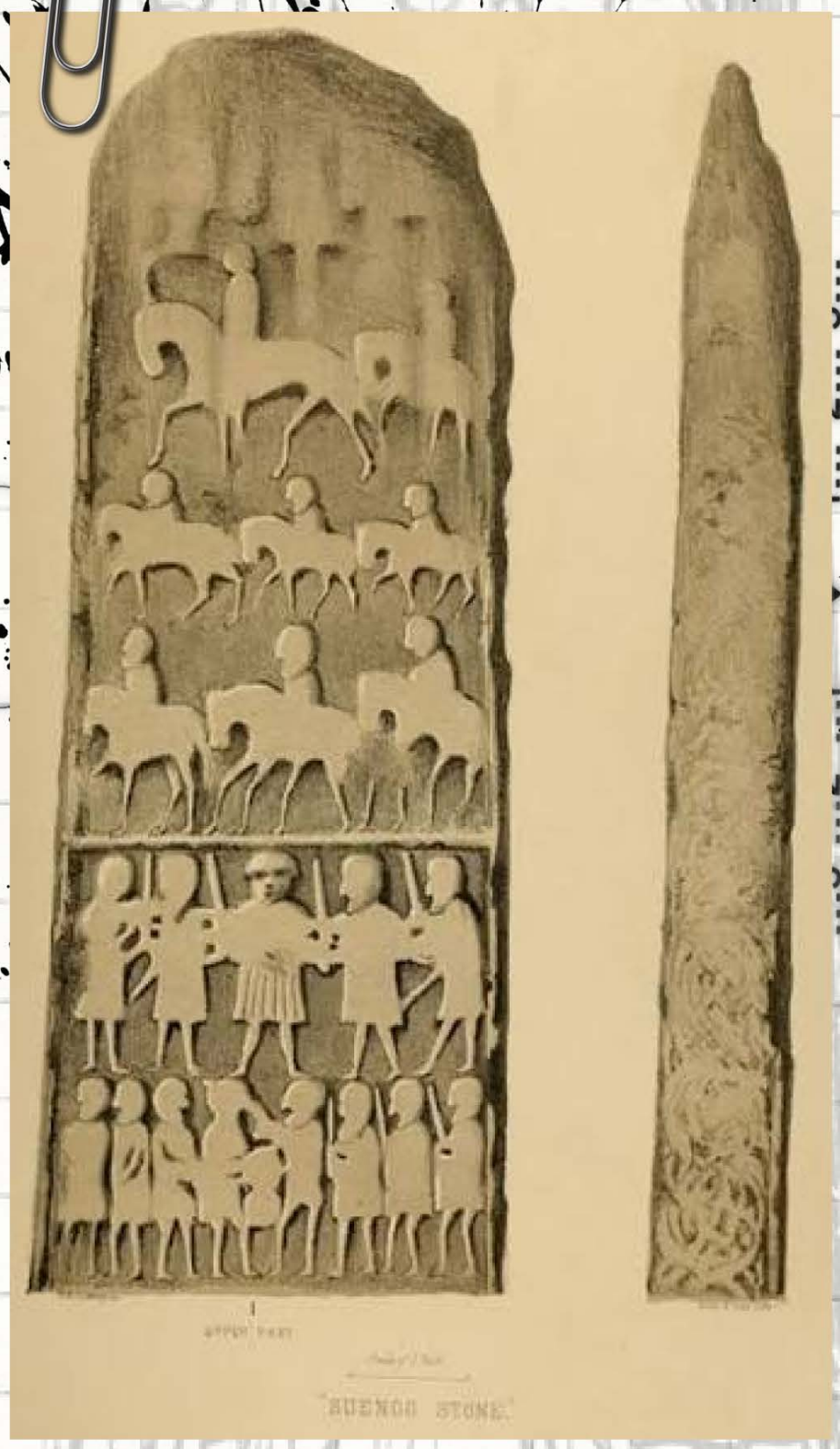
History /

Interpretation



One side focuses on a large Christian cross,

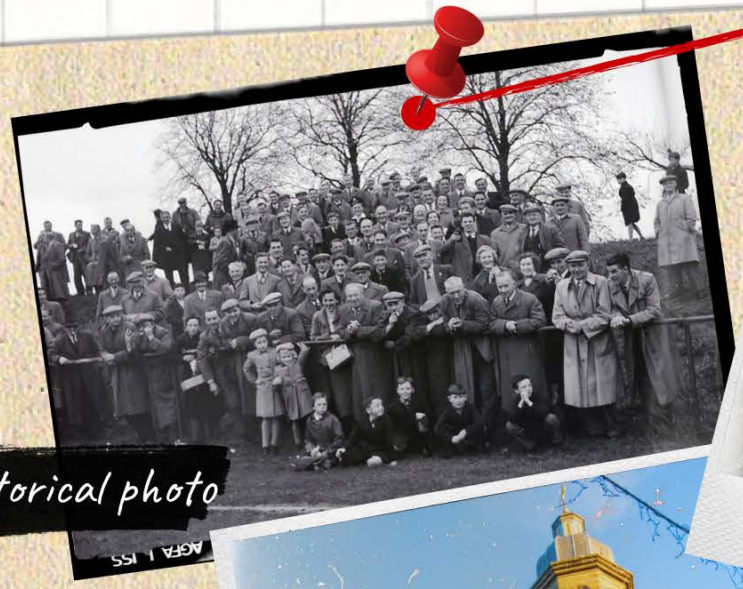
the other shows riders, battles and human figures.



Located on the eastern side of Forres, Sueno's Stone is one of Scotland's most significant **early medieval carved stones**. Standing around seven metres high, the stone surface contains complex carved images.

Researchers have suggested different interpretations, including possible connections with **power, conflict, religion** and **historical events**.

The original story behind the stone remains open to exploration. This uncertainty forms an important part of Sueno's Stone's value.



historical photo

prison areas

court spaces

upgrade

pop-up shop

Tolbooth: Social Memory Within A Building

Building / History / Community

Forres Tolbooth stands at the centre of High Street and remains an important historic building in the town.

The current building dates from around 1839 and was built on the site of earlier Tolbooth structures.
Historically, buildings of this type supported local administration, law and public management.Forres Tolbooth contained court spaces, prison areas and public offices.
Its internal structure preserves traces of how society operated in different periods.
Courtrooms, cells, staircases and stone details reveal how generations of people used this building.
Over time, the role of Tolbooth continued to develop.

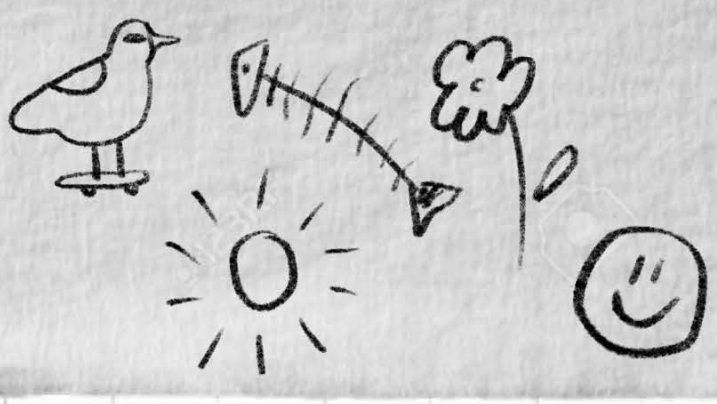
TODAY through care and opening by organisations such as Forres Heritage Trust, the building remains accessible to residents and visitors.People visit, learn and participate in activities, creating new connections with historical space.

Nelson's Tower: Landmark Above the Town

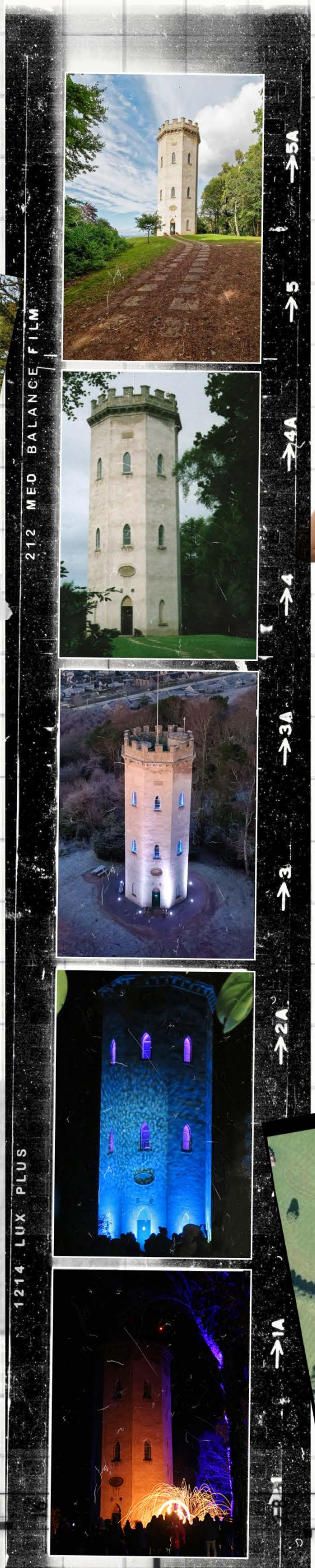
Nelson's Tower stands on the top of Cluny Hill and remains one of the most recognisable landmarks of Forres.

Construction began in 1806 to commemorate Admiral Nelson and the Battle of Trafalgar.

The tower was funded through public donations, showing how communities participated in creating shared memorial spaces during the nineteenth century.



For local people, the meaning of the tower comes from repeated personal experiences.



Today, the building continues through volunteer care and public opening.
Volunteers maintain the space, share its history and help others understand the relationship between the tower and Forres.

The story of Nelson's Tower connects historical memory, natural landscape and personal experience.
It shows how the meaning of a place can continue to develop through use.

Grant Park: A Shared Space for Everyone

Public Space / Activity / Shared Memory

Grant Park and was gifted to the town by Sir Alexander Grant who is now maybe best known as being managing director of McVitie's and developing the recipe of the digestive biscuit.

Grant Park has traditional gardens and the floral sculptures form the centrepiece for the Forres entries in the "Britain and Scotland in Bloom" competitions.
The park has also been the arena for many events including the Forres Highland Games which attracts competitors and visitors from all over the world. The Games traditionally take place on the first weekend of July.

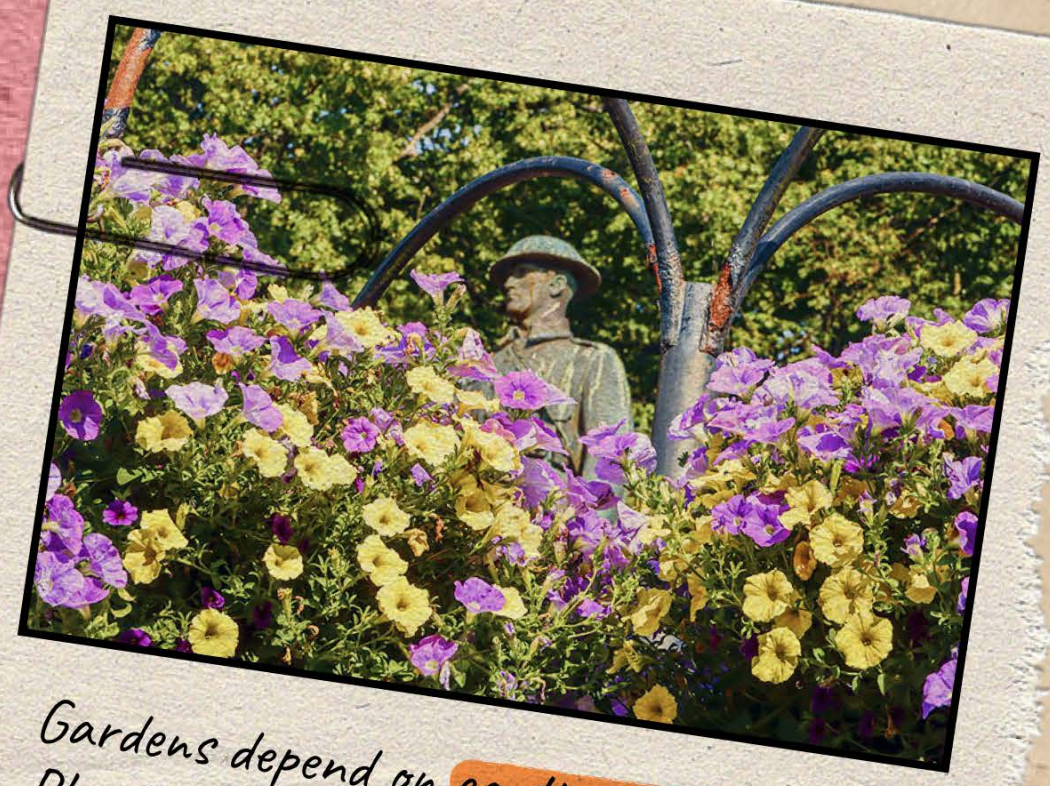
People come for walking, families rest on the grass, children play, and residents pass through the park as part of their daily routes.
During special events, Grant Park becomes a major gathering space for the community.

Chapter 03

Public Landscapes and Environmental Memory

Forres in bloom

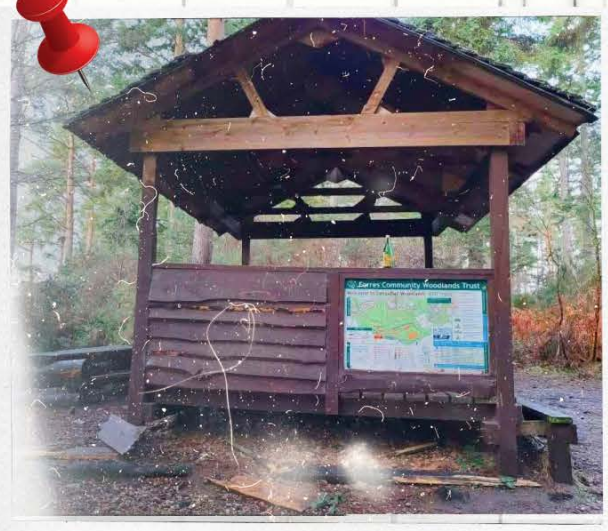
Garden /
Care /
Seasonal Memory



The gardens of Forres represent a relationship between people and their environment.
Residents, volunteers and community groups shape public landscapes through practical actions.
A maintained flower bed, a cared-for pathway or a carefully grown plant can all record the effort people invest in shared spaces.

Gardens depend on continuous care.
Plants require planting, watering, pruning and management. Public spaces need people who continue to pay attention and maintain them.
Much of this work happens quietly in everyday life and is rarely formally recorded, yet it strongly influences how people experience the town.

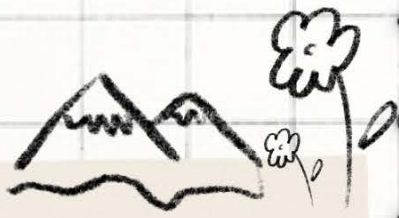
Gardens: Landscapes Created Through Time&Care



Organisations such as Forres Community Woodlands Trust have supported the protection and management of woodland areas, including Muiry Woods and Sanquhar Woodlands.

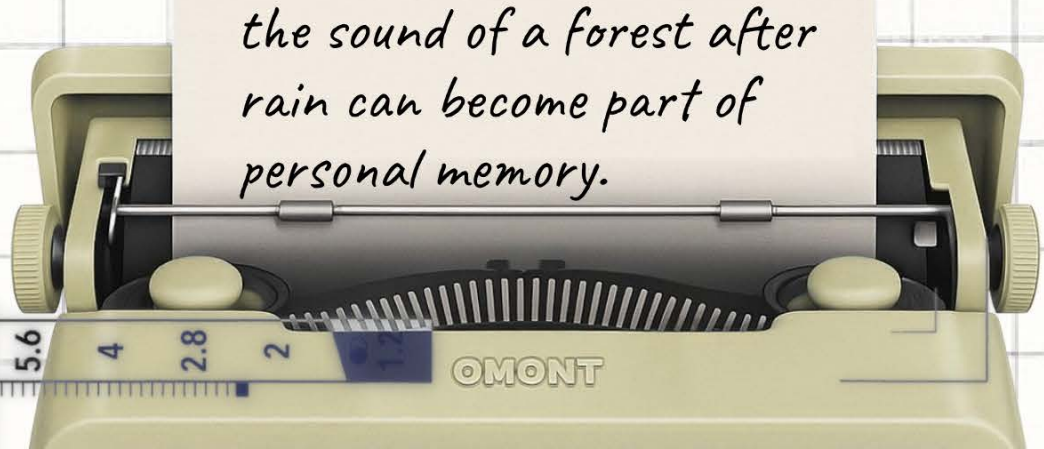
Located between residential areas, roads and natural landscapes, these spaces provide opportunities for people to connect with nature.

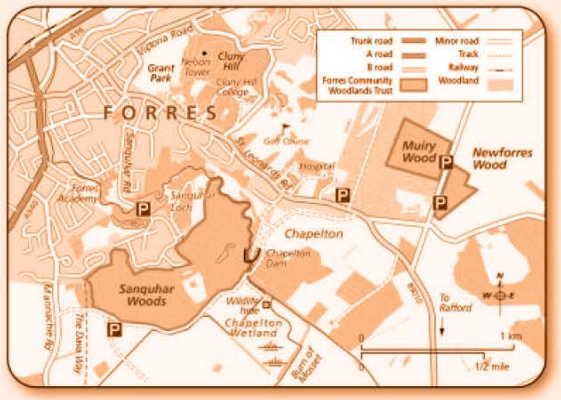
Woodlands: Shared Spaces Between Nature and Everyday Life



boring office

These places support many everyday activities. Residents visit for walking, observing seasonal changes, exploring nature with children and participating in volunteering activities. Paths, sounds and natural experiences create a unique sense of place.A familiar route, a particular tree or the sound of a forest after rain can become part of personal memory.





0 100 200 300 metres

0 100 200 300 yards

Sanquhar Woodlands are Owned and Managed by Forres Community Woodlands Trust

Registered Address:
20 Tolbooth St,
Forres,
IV36 2PH
01309 672244

www.forrescommunitywoodlands.org

The FCWT is a Company Limited by Guarantee No SC202475 and recognised as a Scottish Charity SCO2987

Please respect our woodlands and take your litter home.

Cartography and design:-
www.helenstirlingmaps.com 2016

Sanquhar Loch
Sanquhar Road
Kennel Cottage
Burn of Mosset
Woodend
Loch View
Beech Way
Woodside Drive
Mannachie Rise
Mannachie Avenue
The Dava Way
Sanquhar Woods
Chapelton Dam
Coffin Field
Shelter
Bird Hide
Chapelton Wetland

Map Key

- Road
- Vehicular track
- Broad path
- Narrow path
- Indistinct path
- Steps
- Steep slopes
- Woodland
- Forres Community Woodlands Boundary
- Contours at 2m intervals
- Wetland / pond
- Car park
- Picnic table
- Bench
- Gate
- Viewpoint
- Access points

Mountain Bike Trails

- Blue Grade Trail "Sanquhar Sanction"
- Red Grade Trail "Mannachie Mania"
- Orange Trail "Woodside Wake Up"
- Jumps "Sanquhar Air Space"

Mountain bike trails can also be used by walkers

Walkers and Mountain Bikers.
Please be alert for each other's presence on the shared tracks.

KNOW THE CODE BEFORE YOU GO
outdooraccess-scotland.com

paths for all
FOR A HAPPIER, HEALTHIER SCOTLAND

Water and the Town: Invisible Influences That Shape Forres

Water / Risk / Adaptation

burn of Mosset

River Findhorn

Areas around Pilmuir

The development of Forres has always been connected with its surrounding water environment. Burn of Mosset, River Findhorn and areas around Pilmuir record the long relationship between water and the town.

LOOK!!

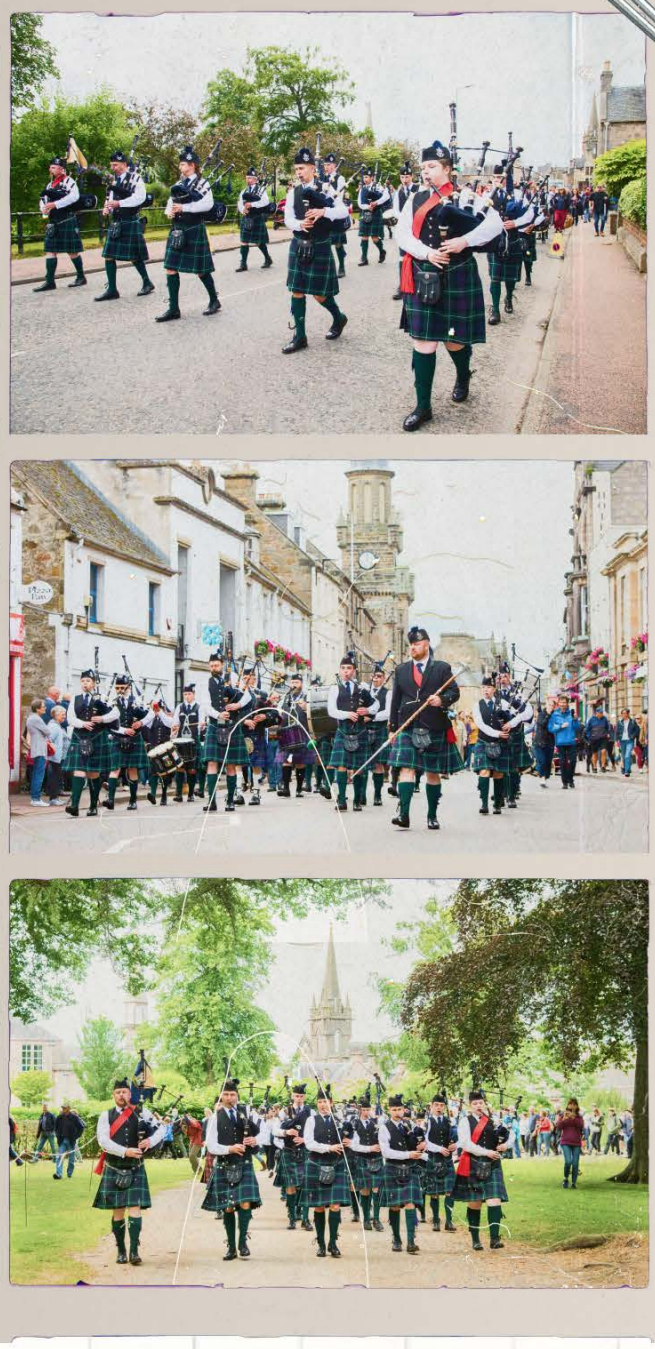
Water supports life and landscapes, while also creating changes and challenges.
Historical flooding affected residents and encouraged the development of flood protection systems.
Through methods such as flood storage, river management and drainage systems, these projects help protect the town.
Many of these infrastructures remain hidden within everyday landscapes.

Chapter 04

Living Forres

Every summer, Forres Highland Games brings people of different ages and backgrounds together at Grant Park.

Forres Highland Games: A Tradition That Happens Again Every Year



Before the event begins, Forres & District Pipe Band marches through High Street, bringing the sound of pipes and drums into the centre of the town.

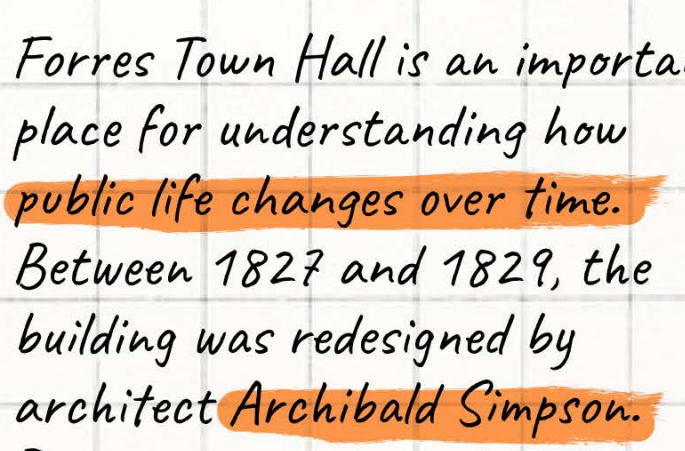
- Open Highland Dancing
- Heavies
- Solo Piping Competition
- Solo Drumming Competition
- Cycling Event
- Track & Field Events
- 10k Road Race
- Tug o' War

Highland dancing, athletics, Heavy Events, tug of war and solo piping performances create the structure of the event.
These activities preserve physical skills connected with Highland culture while allowing participants to experience tradition through training, competition and cooperation.

Town Hall: A Building That Changes With Public Life

Transformation / Public Life / Ownership

Forres Town Hall is an important place for understanding how public life changes over time.
Between 1827 and 1829, the building was redesigned by architect Archibald Simpson.
During the nineteenth century, it was connected with the Mechanics' Institute, providing opportunities for adult education and knowledge exchange.
Later, it became a place for public meetings, dances, performances, social events and local discussions.

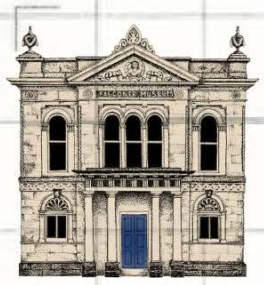


On 26 May 1960, during Johnny Gentle's tour, members of the future Beatles appeared at Town Hall.
This became a unique moment in the building's history and shows how local spaces can connect with wider cultural events.

Today, Town Hall continues to support activities, meetings and community projects.
Its value comes from changing ways of being used.

In 2017, Town Hall faced the possibility of closure.
Forres Area Community Trust later became involved in developing a new community-led future for the building.

Regeneration Project – FACT

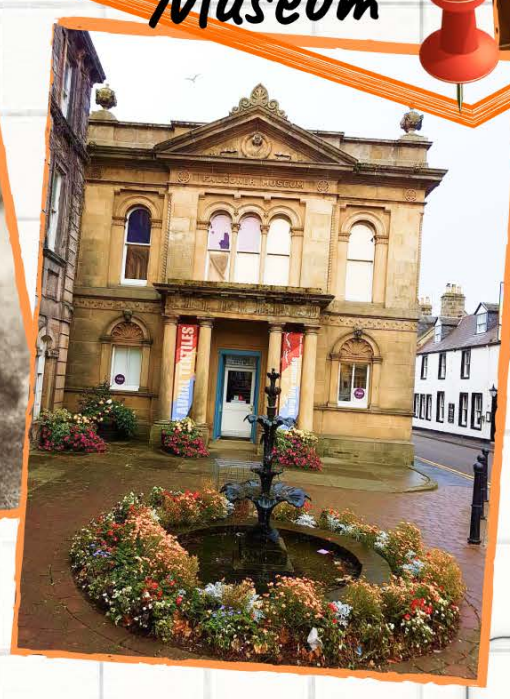


Falconer Museum: When Collections Search for Connection Again

Archive / Absence / Return

Hugh Falconer

Falconer Museum



In 2019, Falconer Museum closed and its future operation entered a period of redevelopment.

Established in 1871, Falconer Museum developed a collection including natural history, archaeological discoveries, local industries and objects connected with the Moray region.

An object, an old photograph or a document can become a connection between past and present.

Through these collections, people learn about previous generations and understand how land, industry and environment have changed.

Whisky: A Story of Land, Labour and Time

Whisky culture around Forres connects natural resources, industrial history and local identity.ogether, these two places reveal different stages of whisky heritage in Forres

Dallas Dhu

The distillery was established in the late nineteenth century, began production in 1899 and continued operating until it closed in 1983.

After closure, Dallas Dhu was preserved as an industrial heritage site.

Its buildings, equipment and production spaces allow people to understand previous methods of whisky making.

It preserves a form of industrial time that has stopped.

Industry

Craft

Time

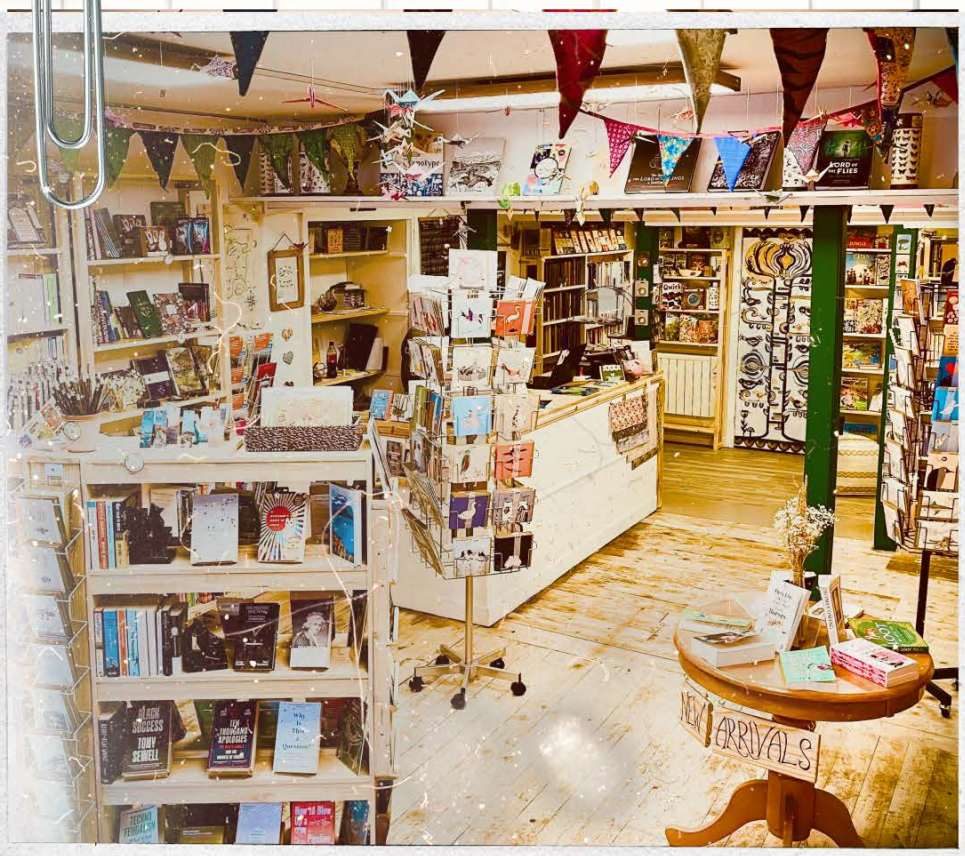
different paths

Benromach

Originally established in 1898, the distillery experienced closure and restoration before returning to production in 1998.

Today, Benromach continues producing whisky through traditional methods while connecting historical techniques with contemporary practice.

Benromach continues creating new production experiences.



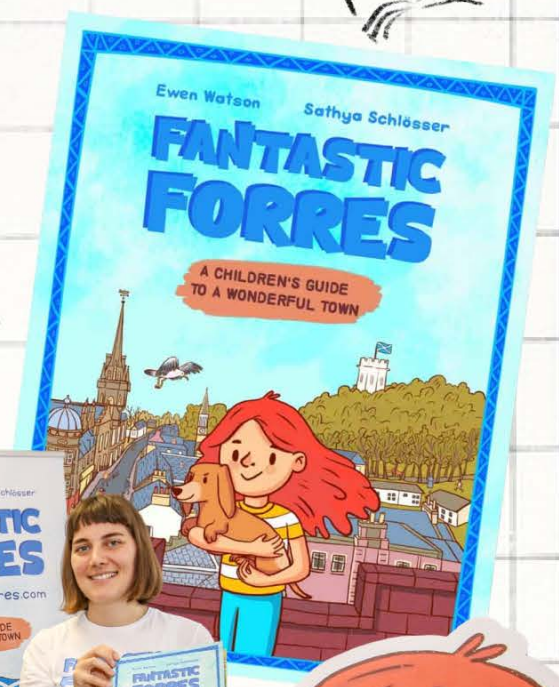
30 High St, Forres
IV36 1DB

Independent Shop / Everyday Culture / Encounter

Located on High Street in Forres, Under the Leaves is an independent bookshop connected with reading, conversation and local culture.

The arrangement of shelves, changing window displays, handwritten recommendations and conversations between customers all become part of High Street's everyday culture.
A small shop can become an entrance point where people meet new stories.

Someone may enter looking for a book and leave with a new understanding of the town. These small encounters are rarely recorded in traditional history, yet they shape the rhythm of local life.



Fantastic Forres, which introduces important places through illustrations and storytelling, allowing residents and visitors to understand the town in an accessible way.

Under the Leaves: Discovering a Place Through a Small Bookshop

The Imaginarium's Missing Museum explored hidden stories through objects and performances created by local artists, young people and residents.

The project connected past, present and future through collective imagination.

The Imaginarium's Missing Museum

Findhorn Bay Arts: Creating Local Stories Together

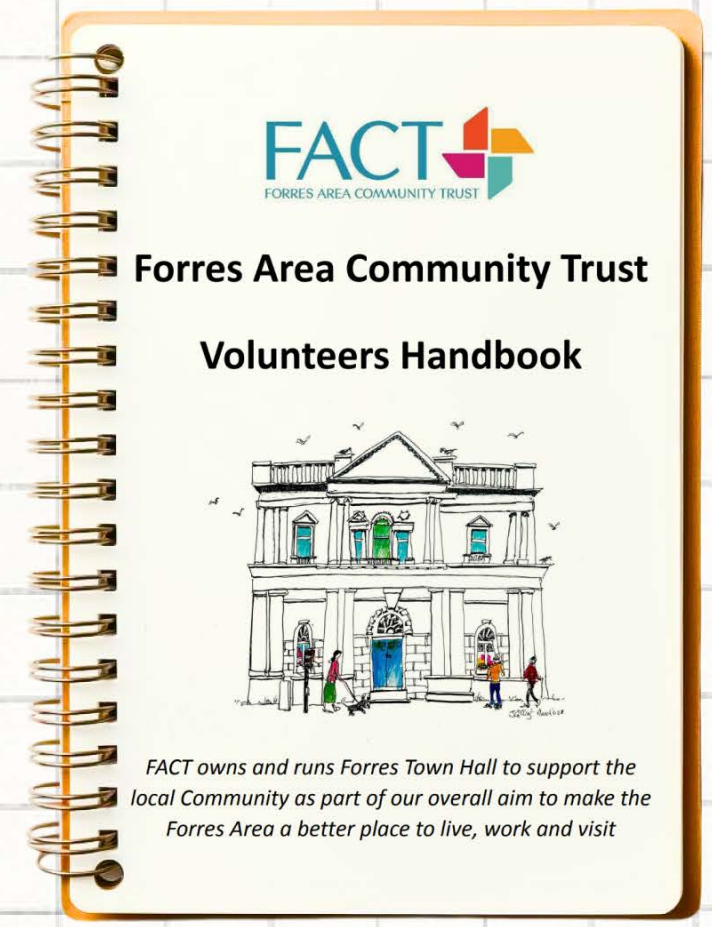
Findhorn Bay Arts is an important arts organisation in Moray.
Through art projects, workshops, exhibitions and community collaborations, it allows residents to participate in creating local culture.
In Forres High Street, the Findhorn Bay Arts Shop & Hub connects art, local food, handmade objects and conversations within one shared space.Cultural production happens through everyday participation.People can join workshops, exchange ideas, create objects and view familiar streets in new ways.

Another project, Unexpected Gardens, focused on lanes and closes behind High Street.
Residents planted together, exchanged edible plants and shared stories and songs.
Spaces that were previously overlooked gained new meanings through participation.

Unexpected Gardens

Forres Area Community Trust (FACT) shows the importance of community organisations in small towns. It responds to practical needs and supports relationships between people through different projects.

FACT: The Community Network Behind Everyday Life



Forres Online

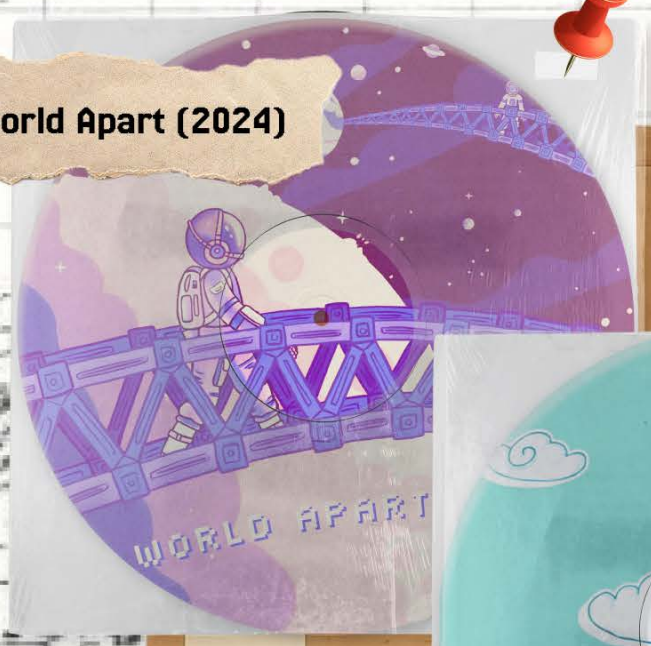
Forres Online provides face-to-face digital support, helping residents with computers, phones and online services.As everyday life becomes increasingly digital, this type of support connects different generations.

Community Food Larder

The Community Food Larder responds to practical needs by providing food support through community spaces including Town Hall.

Befriending Service

The Befriending Service focuses on reducing loneliness and social isolation through companionship and conversation.



A World Apart (2024)

The New Adventures (2013)

The group's debut album, **The New Adventures**, was released in 2013 through Stray Cat Records in the UK and ThisTime Records in Japan, and received a review in the independent music publication, **musicOMH.**

Their second album, **A World Apart,** was released in 2024 and received an in-depth review by **Poprock Record**, where it was named one of the year's must-have LPs.

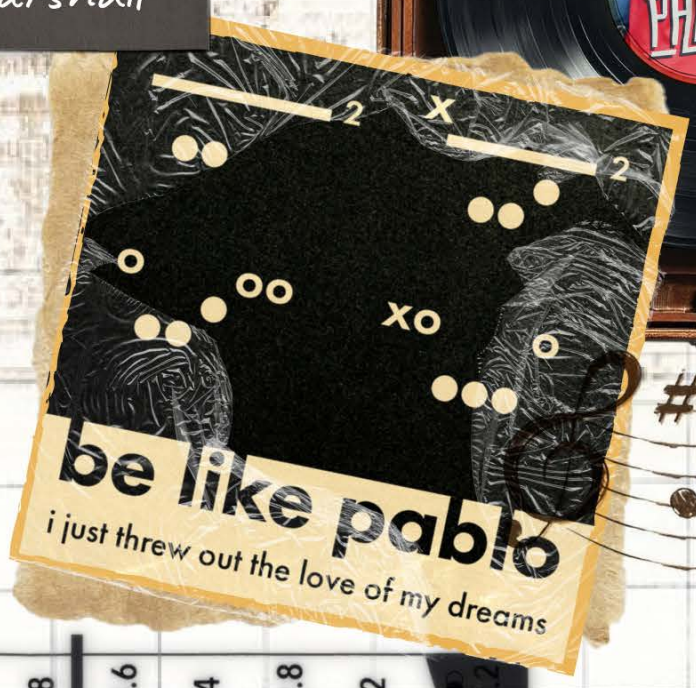
Be Like Pablo were formed in 2010 by brothers Ewen and Ross Watson together with Jamie Murphy.

Be Like Pablo: Young voices creating future heritage

Be Like Pablo are a **Scottish indie power pop band** from Forres, Scotland. Formed in 2010, the band have released two studio albums and several singles, and have performed at UK music festivals and on national radio. Their sound has been described as melodic power-pop with **strong harmonies and retro pop influences.**

- Ewen Watson
- Ross Watson
- Andrew Stepien
- Karen McLauchlan
- Richard Marshall

Be Like Pablo make heart-warming alternative pop anthems with four-part harmonies, noisy guitars and fuzzy synths.



GSA Highlands Campus: A Future Laboratory Within Historic Landscape

The buildings once represented the history of land and ownership.
Today, they provide spaces for design research, teaching, experimentation and collaboration.

The GSA Highlands Campus focuses on postgraduate education and research, particularly design innovation, future challenges and real-world design practice. Students and researchers work through workshops, prototyping, material exploration and collaborations connected with communities and organisations.

Students from different cultural backgrounds become new contributors to local narratives.Through design, photography, sound, research and creative practice, they become future recorders of place.

Near Forres, on the Altyre Estate, a group of Italianate heritage-listed buildings from the 1830s has gained a new role.Previously connected with the history of the estate, these buildings have been transformed into the Glasgow School of Art Highlands and Islands Creative Campus.

“When future generations reopen these materials, they discover a town that continued to live.

Photographs preserve streets at particular moments.
Sounds preserve the atmosphere of a period.
Buildings preserve traces of history.
Stories preserve relationships between people and place.

Every form of record has limitations, but each one carries value.

A stone cannot tell the complete history.
A map cannot capture every personal experience.
An archive cannot preserve every voice.

Therefore, the future gazette of Forres remains open.

New residents will add new stories.
New activities will create new memories.
New methods of recording will appear.

In 2050, researchers continue reading the past while waiting for the next stories to be created.
Because the life of a place comes from being continuously rediscovered.”

FORRES
2 MILES

DALLAS DAM

GRANTOWN
22 MILES

DAVAWAY